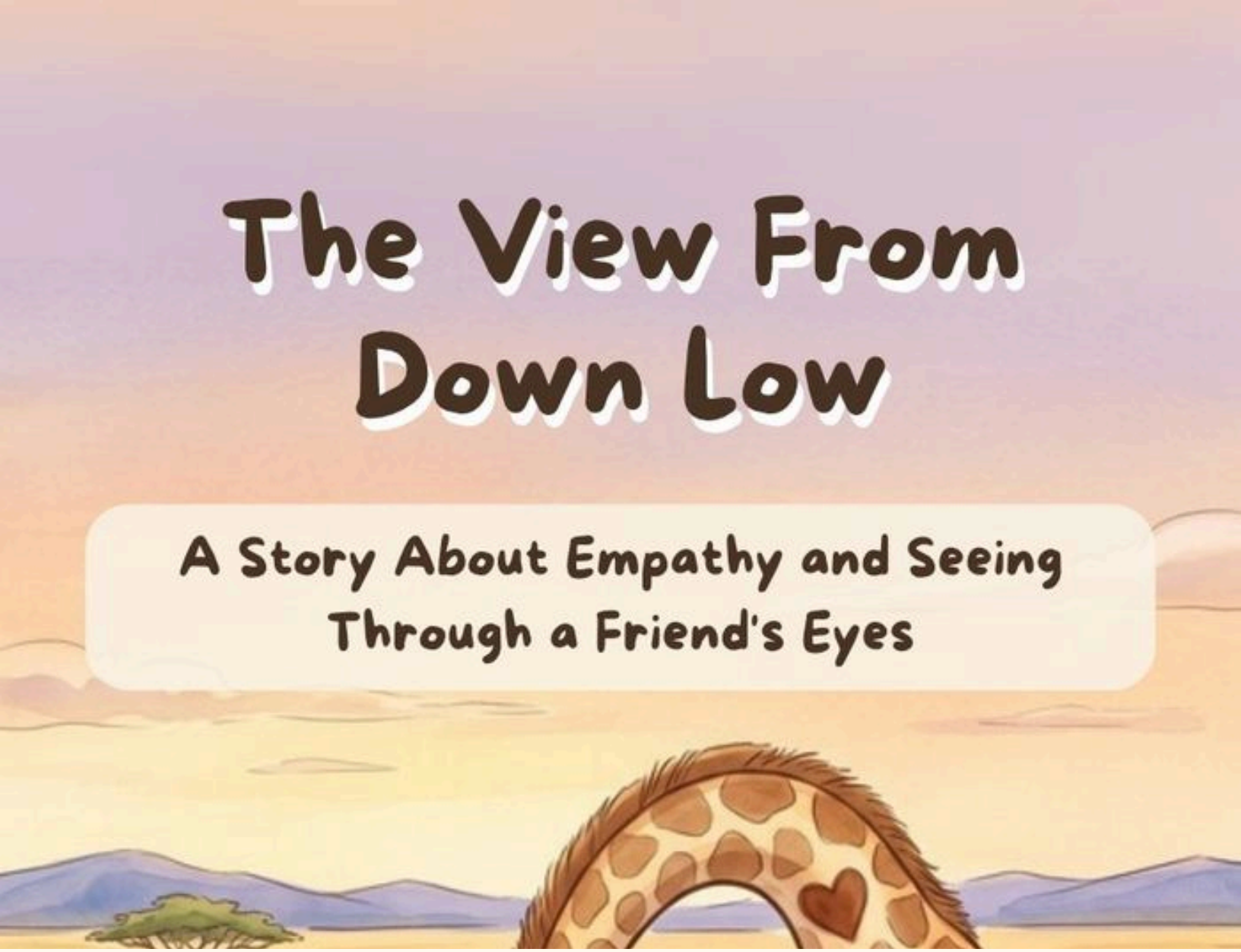


Classroom SEL pack, a week on empathy, ages 3 to 7

The View From Down Low

A five-day plan with everything to print: word cards, a poster, a feelings chart, sequencing cards, activity cards, promise cards, an observation grid, exit tickets and family letters in five languages. The Home Activity Pack is included at the back.

Classroom licence: one teacher may print and copy this pack for their own class and students' families. Please don't share the file or post it online.

The week at a glance

About 20 to 30 minutes a day. Each day stands alone if you only have time for one.

Day	What you do	Print
Day 1 Read and learn the words	Read the story with the pause points. Teach the five words with gestures. Put up the poster and word cards.	Pages 3, 4, 5
Day 2 Feelings	Feelings check-in. Re-read the book and talk about how the characters felt, using the talk questions.	Pages 6, 9
Day 3 Retell	Mix up the sequencing cards and put the story back in order as a class. Retell with “First… Then… At the end…”.	Page 7
Day 4 Down-low walk	Crawl around the classroom at meerkat height. What can you see? What can’t you reach? Then stand on a step stool (with a grown-up) and look down. Talk about how the room …	Page 8
Day 5 Two views drawing	Two views drawing, then promise cards and exit tickets. Send the family letter home.	Pages 8, 10, 14 to 16

Ontario Kindergarten frames

Belonging and Contributing, Self-Regulation and Well-Being, Problem Solving and Innovating, Demonstrating Literacy and Mathematics Behaviours

Materials

The book (or the class screen), a step stool or chair, a tape measure, paper and crayons

Also in this pack

All 12 pages of the Home Activity Pack (from page 17), which you may copy for your class. Book languages: English, French, Spanish, German, Italian.

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Day 1: the read-aloud

Before (3 minutes)

Show the cover. Ask: Who is tall and who is small? What do you think each of them can see? Ask: Is there anything you can't reach or see because you are small? Take a few answers. Teach the refrain: stomp your feet loudly, 'Clomp, clomp, clomp!' Then practise it softly, on tiptoe. Listen for which one Langa uses.

During: stop, ask, listen (10 minutes)

Spread	What happens	Ask	Listen for
3	Themba sneezes in the dust; Langa says everything looks fine.	Why doesn't Langa notice Themba sneezing?	his head is too high, he can't hear or see down there
4	'Why don't you just stretch?'	Can the little animals reach the pods by stretching?	no, they are too small
5	'You can't see it from up there.'	What does Themba mean?	Langa can't see how they feel from so high
6	Langa does the wobbly bow: 'Show me.'	How did it feel for Langa to bend all the way down?	wobbly, silly, hard, brave
7	Dust puffs into Langa's eyes.	What did Langa learn down low?	dust stings, the grass is a forest
8	Langa listens to each friend.	What problems did each friend have?	steep bank, grass hides everything, pods too high
9	Langa makes mud steps and walks softly.	How did Langa help?	steps, bent branches, soft steps
10	Themba says nothing, but Langa notices.	How did Langa know Themba wanted to see, even though he said nothing?	he was on tiptoes, Langa knew the feeling now

Spread numbers match the reader on the class screen. You don't need every stop.

Handle with care: Langa is kind, not a bully. Keep the message that we all miss things until we look from someone else's place. More notes on the "For every child" page.

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Word wall cards

Cut out and add to your word wall. Teach each word with its gesture.

tall

very high from top to bottom

Do it: stretch your hand up high

bend

to lean your body down

Do it: bend over and touch your knees

notice

to see or feel something you didn't see before

Do it: point to your eyes

listen

to pay attention to what someone says

Do it: cup your hand behind your ear

view

what you can see from where you are

Do it: make binoculars with your hands

Clomp, clomp, clomp!

Say it together whenever it comes up in the story.

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When we truly see each other, we all grow taller.

Clomp, clomp, clomp!

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

How do you feel today?

Post at circle time. Children clip a peg with their name on a face.
Characters' feelings change during a story, and ours can too.



happy

clip your name here



sad

clip your name here



worried

clip your name here



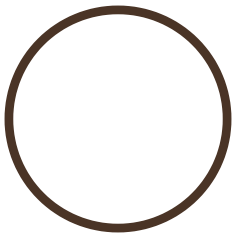
angry

clip your name here



proud

clip your name here



something else

clip your name here

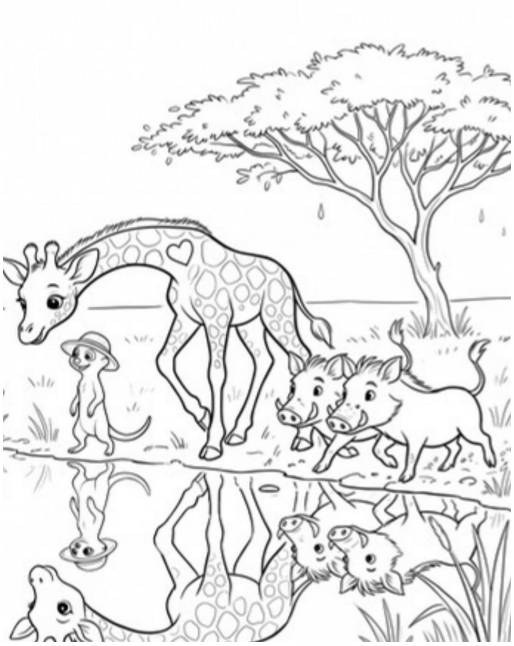
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Sequencing cards

Cut apart for the pocket chart. The four scenes come from the start, two middles and the end of the book, mixed up. Put them in order and retell. Children can color them too.









Answer key, top left to bottom right: 3, 1, 4, 2.

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Activity cards

Cut out and keep with the book. Use one on Day 4 and one on Day 5, or any time.

Down-low walk

10 minutes, Whole class, Materials: None

Crawl around the classroom at meerkat height. What can you see? What can't you reach? Then stand on a step stool (with a grown-up) and look down. Talk about how the room looked different.

Two views drawing

15 minutes, Pairs, Materials: Paper folded in half, crayons

On one half, draw what Langa sees from up high. On the other half, draw what Themba sees down low. Share with a partner.

We see you

5 minutes, Whole class, Materials: None

In circle, each child looks at the next child and says 'I see you.' The friend answers 'I am here.' Pass it around.

Science and nature corner

Giraffes are the tallest land animals. They eat acacia leaves with long tongues, and to drink they must spread their front legs wide and bend their necks all the way down. Their two horn-like bumps are called ossicones. Meerkats are small mongooses that live in groups in the dry lands of southern Africa, and they take turns standing tall on guard. Leopard tortoises, guineafowl and warthogs share the same savanna.

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Talk together

Use after reading, at circle time or with a small group. Accept every honest answer.

1. Why didn't Langa notice that his friends were unhappy?

Look for: He was so tall that he couldn't see or hear what was happening down low.

2. How did it feel for Langa to bend all the way down?

Look for: Wobbly and silly, but he wanted to know.

3. What did he learn when he was down low?

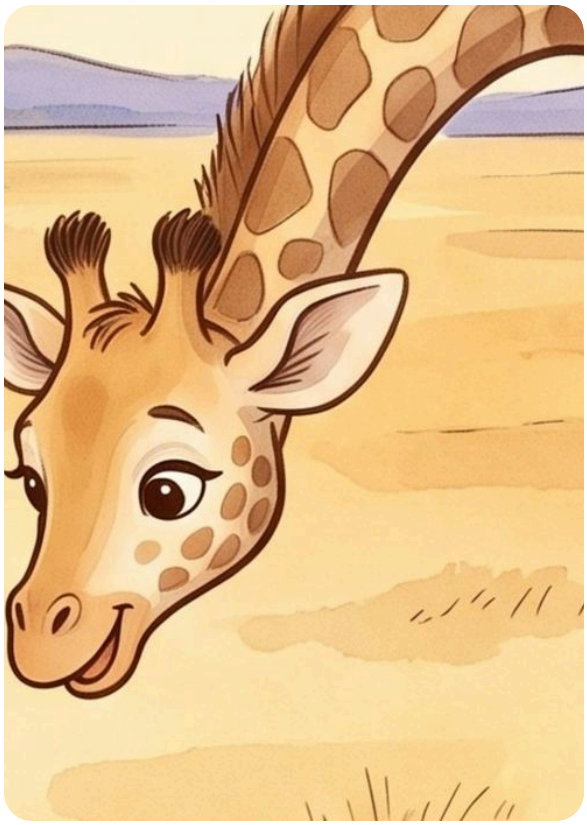
Look for: How dust, tall grass and the steep bank felt for his friends.

4. How did he know Themba wanted to see the sunset?

Look for: He saw Themba on tiptoe and remembered the feeling.

5. When could you 'bend down' to see how a friend feels?

Look for: Any answer: when a friend is quiet, sad, or left behind.



Say it together

Clomp, clomp, clomp!

The big idea: To understand a friend, go to where they are and see what they see. Listen first, then help.

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Promise cards

Each child writes or draws one way they can show empathy this week.
Hang them up, then check back on Friday.



I can show empathy by

Name _____



I can show empathy by

Name _____



I can show empathy by

Name _____



I can show empathy by

Name _____

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What to look for

Tick what you notice during the week. Each column names the Ontario frame it shows.

Child	Belonging and Contributing	Self-Regulation and Well-Being	Problem Solving and Innovating	Demonstrating Literacy and Mathematics Behaviours	Notes

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Science and place corner

The book's golden plain has no name, so we picked a real place where giraffes, meerkats, leopard tortoises, guineafowl and warthogs all live: Tswalu Kalahari Reserve in South Africa.



Giraffe

Giraffe moms give birth standing up, so the baby drops about 2 metres to the ground. Ouch! But within an hour it's standing.



Meerkat

Jackals, martial eagles and tawny eagles are a meerkat's most dangerous enemies. That's why the lookout always watches the sky.



Leopard tortoise

Leopard tortoise eggs take 240 to 400 days to hatch. That's up to more than a year!



Helmeted guineafowl keets

When danger comes, the whole flock shouts a loud rattling "kek-kek-kek-krrrrr" that gets faster and faster.



Common warthog

A startled warthog can run up to 50 km/h.

Tswalu Kalahari Reserve, South Africa

Langa: Real giraffes really do have trouble bending down: it's a wobbly, risky move. But a giraffe's horns, called ossicones, are real, and its heart-shaped neck patch is our artist's idea.

Themba: Real meerkats really do stand up tall to see further, just like Themba. But they don't wear grass hats! And real meerkats almost never hang out with giraffes.

Kulu: Real leopard tortoises really are slow and steady. The acacia leaf stuck on Kulu's shell is our artist's idea, though one could easily get stuck there!

Facts and sources: doubleadventure.ca/heroes/the-view-from-down-low

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For every child

English and French learners

Watch the read-aloud first. Use your body to show tall, small, up and down. The refrain is a sound, loud and soft, so everyone can join.

Children who need more support

Use three stops (spreads 5, 7 and 11). Do the down-low walk before reading so the idea is clear.

Mixed ages and older children

Older children pair with younger buddies and ‘bend down’ to read with them, asking what they see in the pictures.

Handle with care

Langa is kind, not a bully. Keep the message that we all miss things until we look from someone else’s place.

Some children are smaller or use mobility aids. Keep the focus on seeing each other, never on any child’s size or body.

Ubuntu belongs to the peoples of Southern Africa. Share it simply and respectfully, and invite families from the region to share the greeting if they wish.

Where this value comes from

In Southern Africa, the Zulu, Xhosa and other Nguni peoples speak of Ubuntu: a person is a person through other people. The everyday Zulu greeting Sawubona means ‘we see you’, and the answer, Ngikhona, means ‘I am here’.

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Family letters

Cut apart and send home in the family's language, or copy the text into your newsletter.



English

Today we read The View From Down Low, a story about empathy. Langa the giraffe bends all the way down to see the world through his small friend's eyes, and learns to listen before he helps. At home, try getting down to your child's height together and talk about what looks different from there. You can watch or read the story together for free at doubleadventure.ca.



Français

Aujourd'hui, nous avons lu Le Point de vue d'en bas, une histoire sur l'empathie. Langa la girafe se penche jusqu'en bas pour voir le monde avec les yeux de son petit ami, et apprend à écouter avant d'aider. À la maison, mettez-vous à la hauteur de votre enfant et parlez ensemble de ce qui paraît différent d'en bas. Vous pouvez lire ou regarder l'histoire gratuitement sur doubleadventure.ca.



Español

Hoy leímos un cuento sobre la empatía. Langa, la jirafa, se agacha hasta abajo para ver el mundo con los ojos de su pequeño amigo, y aprende a escuchar antes de ayudar. En casa, pónganse a la altura de su hijo o hija y hablen de lo que se ve distinto desde ahí. Pueden leer o ver el cuento gratis en doubleadventure.ca.

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Family letters

Continued.



Deutsch

Heute haben wir eine Geschichte über Einfühlungsvermögen gelesen. Die Giraffe Langa beugt sich ganz nach unten, um die Welt mit den Augen ihres kleinen Freundes zu sehen, und lernt, zuerst zuzuhören und dann zu helfen. Gehen Sie zu Hause gemeinsam auf die Augenhöhe Ihres Kindes und sprechen Sie darüber, was von dort anders aussieht. Die Geschichte gibt es kostenlos auf doubleadventure.ca.



Italiano

Oggi abbiamo letto una storia sull’empatia. Langa, la giraffa, si piega fino in basso per vedere il mondo con gli occhi del suo piccolo amico, e impara ad ascoltare prima di aiutare. A casa, mettetevi all’altezza di vostro figlio o vostra figlia e parlate di ciò che da lì sembra diverso. Potete leggere o guardare la storia gratis su doubleadventure.ca.

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Exit tickets

Read each line aloud. Children tick what they can do and circle a face.
Four tickets per page.

Name _____

Empathy: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

Empathy: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

Empathy: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

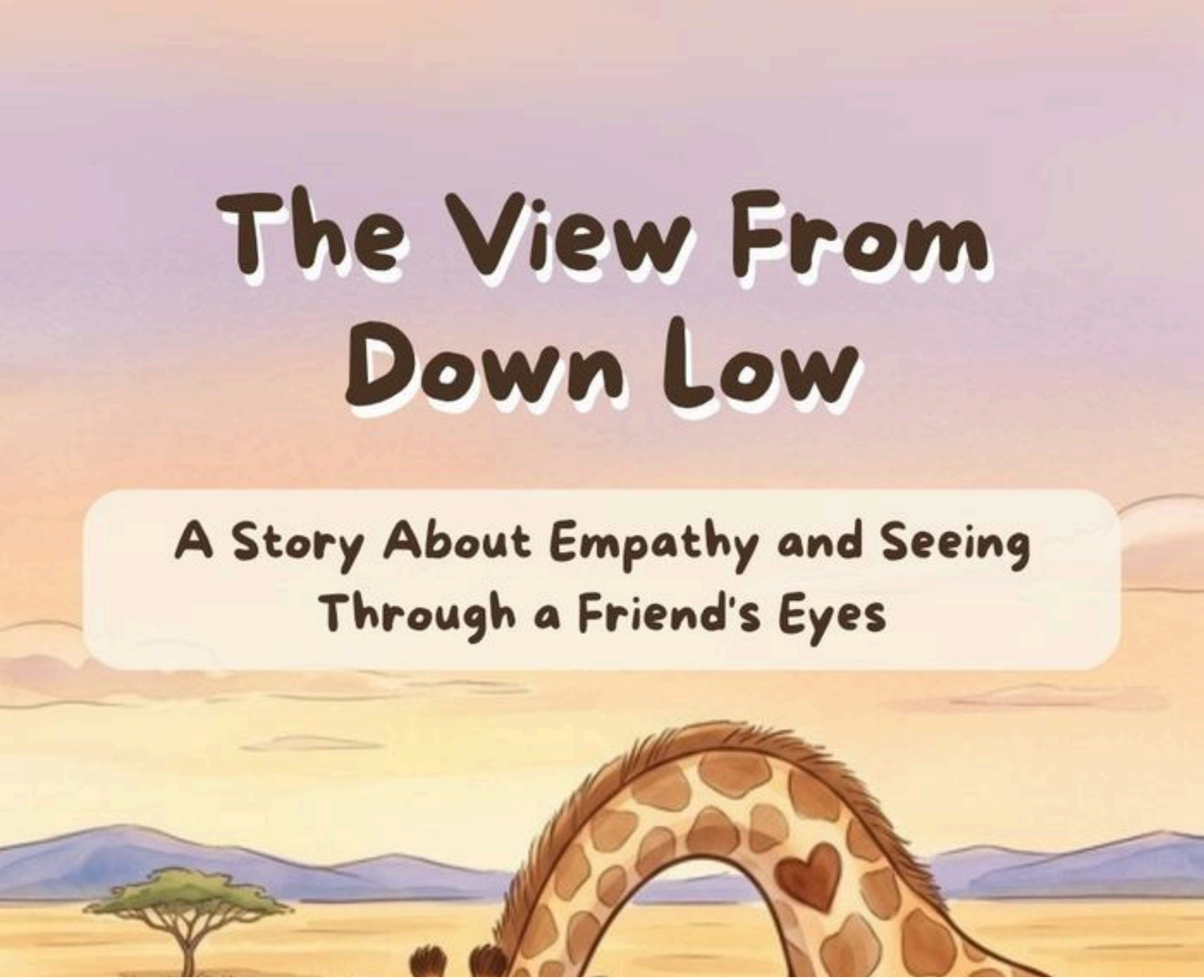
Empathy: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

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Home activity pack, ages 3 to 7

The View From Down Low

Twelve pages to color, cut, trace, make and talk about, all from the story.
The value in this book: empathy.

For use in your own home. Please don't share the file or post it online.

For grown-ups

Read the story first, then pick one page a day. Each page takes 10 to 20 minutes. There are no wrong answers.

The big idea

To understand a friend, go to where they are and see what they see. Listen first, then help.

Say it together

Clomp, clomp, clomp!

Five words from the story

Word	What it means	Do it
tall	very high from top to bottom	stretch your hand up high
bend	to lean your body down	bend over and touch your knees
notice	to see or feel something you didn't see before	point to your eyes
listen	to pay attention to what someone says	cup your hand behind your ear
view	what you can see from where you are	make binoculars with your hands

A gentle note

Langa is kind, not a bully. Keep the message that we all miss things until we look from someone else's place.

Some children are smaller or use mobility aids. Keep the focus on seeing each other, never on any child's size or body.

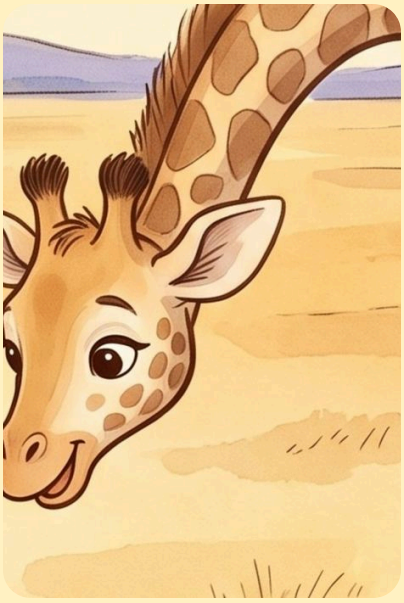
What you need

Crayons, a pencil, scissors, glue or tape, a few craft sticks or straws, and the book (or read it free on screen at doubleadventure.ca).

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Meet the friends

Cut out each card along the dashed line. Tape a craft stick on the back and you have a puppet. Act out the story!



Langa

Giraffe

The tallest one, learning to see what's down low



Themba

Meerkat

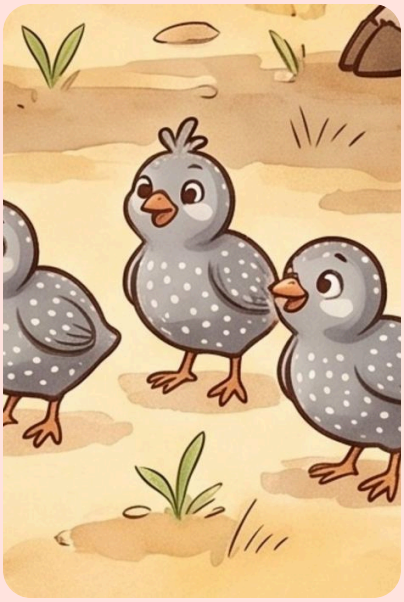
The small friend who shows Langa the view from down low



Kulu

Leopard tortoise

The slow, wise friend at the waterhole



The three chicks

Helmeted guineafowl keets

Little ones who can't reach the pods



The warthog twins

Common warthog

Muddy-nosed twins who need things low

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How did they feel?

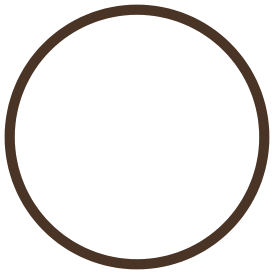
Feelings change during a story. Talk about each moment, then draw how the character felt.

Moment 1

Themba sneezes in the dust; Langa says everything looks fine.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

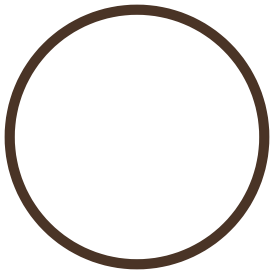


Moment 2

Dust puffs into Langa's eyes.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

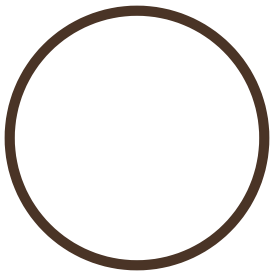


Moment 3

Themba says nothing, but Langa notices.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm



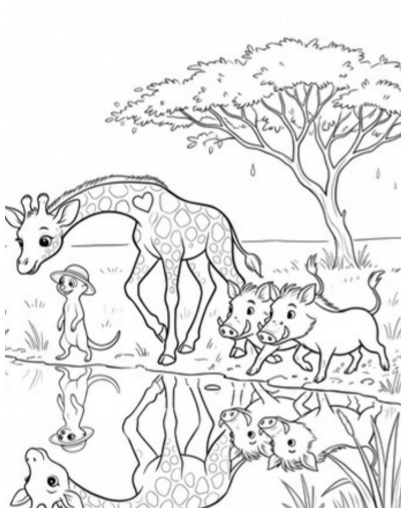
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Story in order

Color the pictures. Write 1, 2 and 3 in the boxes to show what happened first, next and last. Then cut them out and tell the story.



Color me ☐



Color me ☐



Color me ☐

Tell it in your own words

First, _____

Then, _____

At the end, _____

For grown-ups: the pictures come from the start, the middle and the end of the book. Younger children can just point and tell.

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Trace the words

Trace each word with a pencil. Then try writing it on your own in the empty space.

tall very high from top to bottom

tall tall

bend to lean your body down

bend bend

notice to see or feel something you didn't see before

notice notice

Langa the hero of the story

Langa Langa

Write your name

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Draw your own story

Langa showed empathy. Draw a time when you showed empathy too, or a time you could.



Tell a grown-up: What happened? How did you feel? How did the other person feel?

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Make and do

Pick one to try today. Each one comes straight from the story.

Two views drawing

You need: Paper folded in half, crayons

On one half, draw what Langa sees from up high. On the other half, draw what Themba sees down low. Share with a partner.

Down low walk

Crouch down to a toddler's height and walk around your home. What can't you see from down there?

Up high look

Stand on a safe step with a grown-up. What new things can you see from up high?

Meerkat lookout

Take turns being the lookout while others play. Call out "kek-kek!" if you spot the 'eagle' (a grown-up).

Draw what you made

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The real animals

The animals in The View From Down Low are based on real ones. Here is something true about each of them.



Langa

Giraffe

Giraffe moms give birth standing up, so the baby drops about 2 metres to the ground. Ouch! But within an hour it's standing.



Themba

Meerkat

Jackals, martial eagles and tawny eagles are a meerkat's most dangerous enemies. That's why the lookout always watches the sky.



Kulu

Leopard tortoise

Leopard tortoise eggs take 240 to 400 days to hatch. That's up to more than a year!



The three chicks

Helmeted guineafowl keets

When danger comes, the whole flock shouts a loud rattling "kek-kek-kek-krrrrr" that gets faster and faster.

Story or real?

Real giraffes really do have trouble bending down: it's a wobbly, risky move. But a giraffe's horns, called ossicones, are real, and its heart-shaped neck patch is our artist's idea.

Where they really live

The book's golden plain has no name, so we picked a real place where giraffes, meerkats, leopard tortoises, guineafowl and warthogs all live: Tswalu Kalahari Reserve in South Africa.

Facts and sources: doubleadventure.ca/heroes/the-view-from-down-low

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Color the story

Color this page from the book. What is happening here?



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Talk together cards

Cut out the cards and keep them in a jar. Pull one out at dinner, in the car or at bedtime.

Who is tall and who is small? What do you think each of them can see?

The View From Down Low, talk card 1

Why didn't Langa notice that his friends were unhappy?

The View From Down Low, talk card 2

How did it feel for Langa to bend all the way down?

The View From Down Low, talk card 3

What did he learn when he was down low?

The View From Down Low, talk card 4

How did he know Themba wanted to see the sunset?

The View From Down Low, talk card 5

When could you 'bend down' to see how a friend feels?

The View From Down Low, talk card 6

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Empathy hero

This is to say that

_____

showed empathy, just like Langa.

Clomp, clomp, clomp!

_____ _____

Signed Date

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